

Key Gen AI Terms at a Glance

Term	Plain-language meaning
Generative AI	Software that creates new text, images, audio, or code by learning patterns from data.
LLM (Large Language Model)	A very big neural network trained on internet-scale text to predict and generate words in context.
Attention	A mechanism that lets a model focus on the most relevant words when generating or translating text.
GAN (Generative Adversarial Network)	Starts with random noise and gradually “denoises” it to produce photorealistic images or video.
Token	The smallest text chunk a model processes—may be a word, syllable, or character.
Transformer	Model architecture that uses “attention” so every word can weigh every other word—backbone of modern LLMs.
Embedding	A numeric vector that captures the meaning of a word or document so machines can compare similarity.
Fine-tuning	Retraining a pre-built model on your data so it speaks your jargon or follows your style.
Prompt Engineering	Craft clear instructions, role, task, and context to guide an AI model's output.
RAG (Retrieval-augmented Generation)	A technique that fetches company documents and feeds them to the model to ground answers in facts.
Hallucination	Confident-sounding output that isn’t true because the model guesses instead of retrieving facts.
Bias	Systematic skew in AI output caused by imbalanced or prejudiced training data.
Multimodal Model	AI that understands and produces multiple data types, text, images, and audio in a single conversation.
Agent	An AI system that chains multiple steps/tools (e.g., search + email) to achieve a user goal autonomously.